Contend for the Faith

Charts from the six studies

Leader resource · drawn from Studies 1–6 · NASB

The Gospel Vault

The series at a glance

Six studies through Jude's 25 verses

Study	Passage	Title	Proposition in brief
1	Jude 1–2	Standing in the Storm: Grace, Mercy, and Peace	Before believers contend, they are reminded who they are — called, loved, kept — with mercy, peace, and love multiplied
2	Jude 3–4	The Battle Cry: Contend Earnestly for the Faith	Contend earnestly — and graciously — for the once-for-all faith against those who turn grace into license
3	Jude 5–11	Three Warnings from History: When Grace Is Misused	God faithfully judges contempt for His grace and authority; like Michael, leave judgment to the Lord
4	Jude 12–16	Portraits of Apostasy: What False Teachers Look Like	Recognize empty, self-serving religion and rest in the certainty of the Lord's judgment
5	Jude 17–23	The Believer's Response: Build, Pray, Keep, Rescue	Remember the apostles, keep yourselves in God's love, and reach out in discerning mercy
6	Jude 24–25	The Doxology of Confidence: He Is Able	God is able to guard His people and present them blameless with great joy — to Him be glory

Study 1 of 6 · Jude 1–2

Standing in the Storm: Grace, Mercy, and Peace

Before believers are called to contend for the faith, they are reminded of who they are: called, loved, and kept by God.

Jude: from unbelief to bond-servant

The writer behind the letter (v.1a)

Grew up with Jesus	Did not believe	Met the risen Lord	Among the believers	A bond-servant	Mercy for doubters
"His brothers, James and Joseph and Simon and Judas" **Matt 13:55**	*"Not even His brothers were believing in Him"* **John 7:5; Mark 3:21**	*The risen Christ "appeared to James"* **1 Cor 15:7**	*Mary and "His brothers" praying in the upper room* **Acts 1:14**	*"Jude, a bond-servant of Jesus Christ" — doulos* **Jude 1**	*"Have mercy on some, who are doubting"* **Jude 22**

He could have written "brother of the Lord." He wrote "bond-servant of Jesus Christ" — and later calls Jesus "our only Master" (despotēs, v.4). He bows before he speaks.

Called · beloved · kept

Three things God has done (v.1b)

Called
κλητοῖς klētos · adj. (substantival)

- Placed last for emphasis — but first in experience
- God took the initiative; His call, answered by faith, is a settled fact (Rom 1:6–7)

Beloved in God the Father
ἠγαπημένοις agapaō · perf. pass. ptc.

- Loved in the past and still loved — not a love on probation
- They live inside it; v.21 tells them to stay there
- Majority Text: "sanctified" — also perf. pass., same force

Kept for Jesus Christ
τετηρημένοις tēreō · perf. pass. ptc.

- Kept, and remaining kept — God is the keeper
- The letter's frame word (vv.1, 6, 13, 21; cf. v.24)

All three hang on a single article — three views of the same people. Every word describes what God has done; none describes the readers' performance.

The "keep" frame

The letter's frame word, traced through Jude

v.1	*"…called, beloved in God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ"*	**τετηρημένοις** tēreō · perf. pass. ptc. — kept, and remaining kept
v.6	*"angels who did not keep their own domain… He has kept in eternal bonds"*	**τηρήσαντας · τετήρηκεν** Those who would not keep their place are kept in a place they did not choose
v.13	*"for whom the black darkness has been reserved forever"*	**τετήρηται** "Reserved" is tēreō — darkness kept for them
v.21	*"keep yourselves in the love of God"*	**τηρήσατε** aor. act. impv. — stay in the enjoyment of a love already given
v.24	*"Him who is able to keep you from stumbling"*	**φυλάξαι** phylassō — to guard, a sentry's word (not tēreō)

The commands sit inside the frame, not outside it. The believer's responsibility to live in God's love is never the foundation of his security; God's keeping is.

Mercy, peace, and love — multiplied

The greeting (v.2) and where each word returns

Mercy

ἔλεος · eleos

LXX: chesed — steadfast covenant love

Returns in vv.21–23: mercy awaited from Christ becomes mercy extended to the doubting

Peace

εἰρήνη · eirēnē

LXX: shalom — wholeness under God

Peace in the storm, not from it — the intruders are still there in v.4

Love

ἀγάπη · agapē

Echoes "beloved" (v.1)

Returns in the "love feasts" (v.12) and "keep yourselves in the love of God" (v.21)

"Be multiplied" — plēthyntheiē, aorist passive optative: a prayer for abundance, not rationing. God's supply grows as the pressure grows.

Assurance: where does it rest?

Reformed and Free Grace readings of "kept for Jesus Christ" (v.1)

Agreement God preserves His people (Canons of Dort, Fifth Head; Murray, Redemption Accomplished and Applied).

Reformed (counterpoint)

- God's preserving work necessarily produces the believer's perseverance in faith and holiness to the end
- Assurance comes, at least in part, from examining that perseverance (WCF 18.3; Schreiner and Caneday, The Race Set Before Us)

Free Grace (series view)

- God's keeping is itself the guarantee — it does not depend on the believer's grip
- Assurance comes from looking at the promise and the One who keeps, not inward at our record (Dillow; Wilkin, Confident in Christ)
- Calvin: faith is "a firm and certain knowledge of God's benevolence" (Inst. 3.2.7)

The warnings of this letter are real — but they are not designed to make kept people wonder whether they are kept. (Study 1 §III.C)

Study 2 of 6 · Jude 3–4

The Battle Cry: Contend Earnestly for the Faith

Because false teachers have turned God's grace into a license for sin, believers are called to contend earnestly — and graciously — for the once-for-all faith.

The letter Jude did not write

The change of plans (v.3)

The letter he planned
"our common salvation"

- koinos — shared, held in common (cf. "common faith," Titus 1:4)
- One salvation, held equally by every believer — not graded by performance
- A celebration

→

The letter he wrote
"contend earnestly for the faith"

- "I felt the necessity" — anankēn eschon, the language of compulsion (cf. 1 Cor 9:16)
- Love for the church left him no choice
- A summons

v.3 gives the charge; v.4 gives the reason. Everything from v.5 to v.23 develops either the danger of v.4 or the response of v.3.

The charge, phrase by phrase

v.3b · "contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all handed down to the saints"

Phrase	Greek	What it means
contend earnestly	epagōnizesthai · pres. inf. (NT hapax)	From agōn, an athletic contest — an ongoing, strenuous struggle; in the manner of vv.9 and 20–23, not quarrelsomeness (2 Tim 2:24–25)
the faith	tē pistei · with the article	The content believed — the gospel and apostolic teaching. The struggle is for the message, not for the believer's standing
once for all	hapax	Decisive and unrepeatable (cf. Heb 9:26) — delivered complete
handed down	paradotheisē · aor. pass. ptc.	Technical term for authoritative tradition (1 Cor 15:3) — no later, "more enlightened" version
to the saints	tois hagiois	Entrusted to every believer, not a professional class

Five marks of the intruders

v.4 · the reason for the charge

1	**Crept in unnoticed**	**pareisedysan**	Slipped in by a side door — the danger came from within, quietly (cf. Gal 2:4)
2	**Long beforehand marked out for this condemnation**	**progegrammenoi**	"Written beforehand" — their condemnation already on the page in vv.5–16
3	**Ungodly persons**	**asebeis**	Jude's signature word (vv.4, 15, 18) — a settled orientation, not struggling believers
4	**Turn the grace of our God into licentiousness**	**aselgeia**	Unrestrained sensuality — grace twisted into a license to sin
5	**Deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ**	**arnoumenoi · despotēn**	An ongoing pattern; the despotēs Jude serves as doulos (v.1), they reject

"They claimed the benefits of grace while refusing the Lord of grace." Jude does not call them believers: they are "devoid of the Spirit" (v.19).

"Long beforehand marked out"

Two readings of v.4

Reformed (counterpoint)

- A statement of eternal decree: these individuals were foreordained to condemnation (cf. 1 Pet 2:8)
- Draws on the classical doctrine of reprobation (Calvin; Westminster Confession ch.3)

Free Grace / DTS (series view)

- progegrammenoi = "written beforehand" (cf. Rom 15:4)
- Jude immediately says "I desire to remind you" (v.5) and cites written examples and Enoch's prophecy (vv.5–16)
- Their condemnation was already on the page (Constable; Bible Knowledge Commentary; Wilkin, Is Calvinism Biblical?)

The focus stays where Jude puts it: on the certainty of God's judgment against those who corrupt His grace — not on a decree hidden in eternity.

Grace, not license

The charge critics bring against Free Grace — and the answer (v.4)

Agreement Grace is never a license for sin — "Are we to continue in sin so that grace may increase? May it never be!" (Rom 6:1–2)

Lordship Salvation (counterpoint)

- Free Grace teaching leads to the very error Jude condemns (MacArthur, The Gospel According to Jesus)
- Sproul: receiving Jesus as Savior but not as Lord is "antinomianism with a vengeance"
- Remedy: saving faith necessarily includes submission and persevering obedience

Free Grace (series view)

- Keep the gospel offer free, as Jesus gave it (John 4:10; Rev 22:17)
- Press discipleship, holiness, and reward on those who believe — the Judgment Seat (2 Cor 5:10; 1 Cor 3:12–15) and discipline (Heb 12)
- Grace as freedom, not license (Swindoll; Hodges, Absolutely Free!, Grace in Eclipse)

The cure for counterfeit grace is not less grace — it is grace rightly understood, the grace that instructs us to deny ungodliness (Titus 2:11–12).

Study 3 of 6 · Jude 5–11

Three Warnings from History: When Grace Is Misused

History shows that God faithfully judges those who despise His grace and authority; believers learn, like Michael, to leave judgment to the Lord.

How vv.5–11 are built

Example, application, contrast, conclusion, woe

vv.5–7
Three examples
Israel, angels, Sodom

→

v.8
Applied to "these"
defile, reject, revile

→

v.9
Michael in contrast
"The Lord rebuke you!"

→

v.10
The conclusion
destroyed by instinct

→

v.11
Woe and three men
Cain, Balaam, Korah

Two triads — three collective examples (vv.5–7) and three individuals (v.11) — with the archangel standing between them as the model believers follow.

Three examples, three marks

vv.5–7 matched to the intruders

Example	What was judged	Old Testament	The intruders' matching mark
Israel in the wilderness (v.5)	Unbelief	Num 14:29–35	They deny our only Master and Lord (v.4)
The angels who sinned (v.6)	Rebellion against God's order	Gen 6:1–4, or the original fall; 2 Pet 2:4	They reject authority (v.8)
Sodom and Gomorrah (v.7)	Sexual immorality	Gen 19	They turn grace into sensuality (v.4) and defile the flesh (v.8)

Note Jude's wordplay in v.6: the angels did not keep their domain, so God has kept them in bonds — while believers are "kept for Jesus Christ" (v.1).

Israel in the wilderness (v.5)

Does this verse threaten believers with the loss of eternal life?

Reformed (counterpoint)

- A central text for the view that people who once appeared saved can finally perish if they do not persevere
- NT warnings threaten eternal destruction and are the means God uses to keep the elect persevering (Schreiner and Caneday, The Race Set Before Us)

Free Grace (series view)

- The wilderness judgment was physical death — they did not enter the land
- Moses, Aaron, and Miriam also died outside the land, and no one doubts they were believers
- Paul (1 Cor 10:1–11) and Hebrews (3–4) use this history to warn believers of discipline and lost reward (Dillow; Hodges, BKC "Hebrews")
- Jude applies it to intruders "devoid of the Spirit" (v.19)

The lesson: proximity to God's people protects no one. God judges unbelief, and He is not fooled.

Michael and the intruders

vv.8–10 · two ways of speaking about the spiritual realm

Michael the archangel (v.9)

- In a dispute with the devil himself over the body of Moses
- "Did not dare pronounce against him a railing judgment"
- Said, "The Lord rebuke you!" — the words of Zech 3:2
- He knew his place and referred judgment to God

The intruders (vv.8, 10)

- "Dreamers" — claiming visions that freed them from moral boundaries (cf. Deut 13:1–5)
- Revile angelic majesties
- Revile what they do not understand
- Follow instinct like unreasoning animals — and are destroyed by it

Where does the story come from?

Not in the Old Testament (Deut 34:6). Clement of Alexandria and Origen placed it in the Assumption (Testament) of Moses, whose ending is lost. Quoting a source is not endorsing all of it — Paul quotes pagan poets (Acts 17:28; Titus 1:12). What Jude affirms, Scripture affirms.

Woe to them: Cain, Balaam, Korah

v.11 · walking → running → falling

Cain

"gone the way of"

Old Testament
Gen 4 · Heb 11:4 · 1 John 3:12

The sin
Came to God on his own terms, without faith; resentment, then violence

The pattern
Religion without faith, hostile to those who walk by faith

Balaam

"for pay… rushed headlong into the error of"

Old Testament
Num 22–25; 31:16 · 2 Pet 2:15 · Rev 2:14

The sin
Prophet for hire; advised Balak to lead Israel into immorality and idolatry

The pattern
Profitable teaching that leads God's people into sin

Korah

"perished in the rebellion of"

Old Testament
Num 16:3, 31–35

The sin
A Levite who claimed "all the congregation are holy" while seeking the priesthood

The pattern
Rejecting God-given authority (v.8) — an end as sure as his

"Woe" — a prophet's lament over certain judgment, not a curse spoken in anger. "Perished" is aorist: as certain as if it had already happened.

Privilege did not protect them

Six examples, one message (vv.5–11)

Israel
had been rescued from Egypt

The angels
had been exalted

Sodom
had been warned by Lot

Cain
had been spoken to by God

Balaam
had received true prophecy

Korah
served at the tabernacle

God does not overlook contempt for His grace and His authority. For believers, this is not a threat to eternal life (vv.1, 24) but a call to sobriety — God disciplines His children (Heb 12:6), and all will give account (2 Cor 5:10).

Study 4 of 6 · Jude 12–16

Portraits of Apostasy: What False Teachers Look Like

Jude exposes the false teachers through portraits from nature and the prophecy of Enoch, so that believers can recognize empty, self-serving religion and rest in the Lord's judgment.

Five portraits from creation

vv.12–13 · sea, sky, earth, sea, heavens — promise without substance

Portrait	Realm	Scripture echo	What it exposes
Hidden reefs in your love feasts (spilades) — "caring for themselves"	Sea	Ezek 34 — shepherds who fed themselves	Calm surface, wreck beneath; feasting "without fear"
Clouds without water, carried along by winds	Sky	Prov 25:14	Promised refreshment, delivered none; no stability (Eph 4:14)
Autumn trees without fruit, doubly dead, uprooted	Earth	Matt 7:16–20	Harvest time and nothing on the branches — dead wood
Wild waves of the sea, casting up their own shame like foam	Sea	Isa 57:20	Restless and noisy, producing only shame
Wandering stars, for whom the black darkness has been reserved forever	Heavens	Dan 12:3; 1 Enoch	Guides who lead people off course; darkness kept (tēreō) for them

The counterfeit and the real

Study 4's conclusion: drink deeply from the real thing

Clouds without water	→	**Christ, the living water** John 4:10; 7:37–38
Autumn trees without fruit	→	**Christ, the true Vine — whose life bears fruit in those who abide** John 15:1–5
Wandering stars	→	**Christ, the Bright Morning Star by which we steer** Rev 22:16

"False teachers wander; we are kept."

The fruit test

Who is Jude's portrait meant to examine? (v.12)

Agreement The men Jude describes are unsaved — Jude says so: "devoid of the Spirit" (v.19).

Lordship (counterpoint)

- Fruitless trees are a general test of genuine salvation
- "You will know them by their fruits" (Matt 7:16) — the absence of fruit proves the absence of life (MacArthur, The Gospel According to Jesus)

Free Grace (series view)

- In Matt 7:15–20 and Jude the test is applied to false teachers — including their teaching and its effects (Hodges; Wilkin)
- Jude never tells readers to inspect their own fruit; he tells them they are kept (v.1)
- Believers can be carnal for a time (1 Cor 3:1–3; John 15:2; 2 Pet 1:8–9) — the remedy is abiding, confession, and growth

Use Jude's portraits to recognize false teachers; rest your own assurance on God's promise.

Enoch's prophecy

vv.14–15 · the seventh from Adam

Two "sevenths" from Adam

Line of Seth · 7th: Enoch
"Walked with God; and he was not, for God took him" (Gen 5:24; Heb 11:5)

Line of Cain · 7th: Lamech
Boasted of violence (Gen 4:19–24)

"Ungodly" four times in v.15

asebeis · asebeias · ēsebēsan · asebeis

"to convict all the ungodly of all their ungodly deeds which they have done in an ungodly way, and of all the harsh things which ungodly sinners have spoken against Him"

- "The Lord came" — a prophetic past: the future event is so certain it is described as done
- "His holy ones" — angels and the saints who return with Christ (Deut 33:2; Zech 14:5; Rev 19:14); in this series' premillennial framework, His return at the end of the Tribulation
- The words closely match 1 Enoch 1:9. Jude affirms this prophecy is true; that does not make 1 Enoch Scripture

The plain portrait

v.16 · each trait echoes something earlier in the letter

Trait	Greek	Meaning	Echo in Jude
Grumblers	gongystai	The low, complaining murmur	Israel in the wilderness (v.5; Num 14:27)
Finding fault	mempsimoiroi	"Blaming one's lot" — never content with God's gifts	The same wilderness generation
Following after their own lusts	—	Desire as their compass	Licentiousness (v.4); instinct (v.10)
Speak arrogantly	"swelling words"	Arrogant toward God and His authority	Revile majesties (v.8)
Flattering people for advantage	thaumazontes prosōpa	"Admiring faces" — favoritism (cf. James 2:1–9)	Balaam's profit motive (v.11)

Real shepherds speak the truth in love to everyone alike (Eph 4:15). False shepherds tell people what they want to hear, and choose their audience by what they can get from it.

Study 5 of 6 · Jude 17–23

The Believer's Response: Build, Pray, Keep, Rescue

Believers are called to remember the apostles' warnings, to keep themselves in the enjoyment of God's love, and to reach out in discerning mercy.

"These" and "But you, beloved"

vv.17–21 · two kinds of people

"These" · vv.8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 19	"But you, beloved" · vv.17, 20
Cause divisions (apodiorizontes) — the spiritual elite	Build yourselves up — together (the "yourselves" is plural)
Worldly-minded (psychikoi) — merely natural	On your most holy faith — the faith of v.3
Devoid of the Spirit (pneuma mē echontes)	Praying in the Holy Spirit
Following after their own ungodly lusts (v.18)	Keep yourselves in the love of God
Mockers in the last time (v.18)	Waiting anxiously for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ

"Devoid of the Spirit" is the key to the whole letter: the warnings are aimed at people who never possessed eternal life — not at believers who lost it.

Remember · keep · reach out

Jude's prescription — and his answer to "contend for the faith" (v.3)

Remember
vv.17–19

- "Remember" — aorist imperative
- The apostles saw this coming (Acts 20:29; 1 Tim 4:1; 2 Tim 3:1; 2 Pet 3:3)
- False teachers are a sign the apostles' words are being fulfilled — not that the gospel is failing

Keep yourselves
vv.20–21

- Building on your most holy faith
- Praying in the Holy Spirit
- Keeping yourselves in the love of God
- Waiting for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ

Reach out
vv.22–23

- Mercy to the doubting
- Snatching others from the fire
- Mercy with fear to the entangled

Contending is not primarily debating or denouncing. It is remembering, building, praying, keeping, looking for Christ — and rescuing.

One command, three participles

vv.20–21 · with a Trinitarian shape

Building yourselves up
epoikodomountes
On your most holy faith — the faith of v.3. False teachers erode; believers build, together.

Praying in the Holy Spirit
Prompted, guided, empowered by the Spirit every believer has (Rom 8:26–27; Eph 6:18).
The Spirit

Spirit · Father · Son — "praying in the Holy Spirit… the love of God… the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ"

Keep yourselves in the love of God
tērēsate · aor. act. impv. — the main command

The love of God
God's love for believers — the love in which they are "beloved" (v.1).
The Father

Waiting anxiously for mercy
prosdechomenoi
Eager expectation of the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life (Titus 2:13).
The Son

"Keep yourselves in the love of God"

Two readings of v.21

Reformed (counterpoint)

- Commands like this are conditions believers must meet to obtain eternal life at the end
- God ensures the elect will meet them — keeping oneself in God's love is, in part, keeping oneself saved (Schreiner and Caneday, The Race Set Before Us)

Free Grace (series view)

- "The love of God" is God's love for believers (v.1) — they are already in it
- The command is to remain in the conscious enjoyment of it: "abide in My love" (John 15:9–10)
- Like a child in a loving home: membership settled by birth, but able to wander from the warmth (Hodges; Dillow)

Believers do not keep themselves in God's love to stay saved; they keep themselves in it because they are saved and want to live in the joy of it.

Three kinds of mercy

vv.22–23 · contending reaches outward

Have mercy on the doubting
diakrinomenous

- Wavering, torn between two positions (cf. James 1:6)
- Not dismissed or shamed — shown patience and help
- Jude once doubted his own brother (John 7:5)

Save others, snatching them from the fire
harpazontes

- "A brand plucked from the fire" (Amos 4:11; Zech 3:2)
- Unbelievers near "eternal fire" (v.7) — bring them the gospel
- Or deceived believers headed for sin's ruin (cf. James 5:20)

Have mercy with fear
espilōmenon

- Those deeply entangled in the intruders' immorality
- "Hating even the garment polluted by the flesh" (cf. Zech 3:3–4)
- Love the sinner, refuse the contamination (Gal 6:1)

Mercy does not mean naïveté: we reach into the mud to rescue someone without wallowing in it ourselves. (Manuscripts differ between two and three groups; the NASB follows three.)

Study 6 of 6 · Jude 24–25

The Doxology of Confidence: He Is Able

The letter that called believers to contend ends by lifting their eyes to God, who is able to guard them and present them blameless with great joy.

Him who is able

v.24 · what God is able to do

Him who is able	**tō dynamenō**	He leads with God's ability (Rom 16:25; Eph 3:20; Heb 7:25; 2 Tim 1:12)
to keep you from stumbling	**phylassō · aptaistous**	A sentry's word; "unstumbling" — sure-footed on a rocky path
and to make you stand	**stēsai**	Not admitted by a side door — set in place
in the presence of His glory	**katenōpion**	Face to face before the radiant majesty of God (cf. Isa 6:5)
blameless	**amōmous**	A sacrificial word — without defect (Heb 9:14; 1 Pet 1:19; Col 1:22)
with great joy	**en agalliasei**	Exultant gladness — ours and His (Heb 12:2; Zeph 3:17)

After twenty-three verses of warnings, Jude's answer to "Will I be led astray?" is not "Try harder." It is "God is able to guard you."

Stained or blameless

The contrast Jude draws with one word family

The intruders	The believers
v.12 "hidden reefs" — spilades (or "stains")	**v.24** "blameless" — amōmous, without blemish
v.23 "the garment polluted" — espilōmenon, stained and remaining stained	**How?** Christ's righteousness, credited the moment one believes (Rom 4:5; 2 Cor 5:21; Col 1:22)

Believers will appear at the Judgment Seat of Christ, where works are evaluated and rewards given or lost (2 Cor 5:10; 1 Cor 3:12–15). That evaluation concerns reward, not acceptance. Every believer will stand blameless in Christ.

What belongs to God

v.25 · four ascriptions answer the intruders' challenge

Ascription	Greek	Meaning	What the intruders challenged
Glory	doxa	The radiance of His character, the weight of His worth	—
Majesty	megalōsynē	Transcendent greatness — "the Majesty on high" (Heb 1:3; 8:1)	—
Dominion	kratos	Sovereign might, the power that prevails	They acted as if they could live outside God's rule
Authority	exousia	His rightful claim to rule	They "reject authority" (v.8) and deny "our only Master" (v.4)

before all time | **now** | **forever**

"The false teachers had their moment. God has eternity." — Study 6

What God's power guarantees

Reformed and Free Grace readings of v.24

Agreement The believer's security is grounded in the power of God, not human strength (Murray; Canons of Dort; Schreiner).

Reformed (counterpoint)

- God's keeping power infallibly ensures that every true believer perseveres in faith and holiness to the end
- Perseverance therefore becomes the evidence of genuine faith

Free Grace (series view)

- The guarantee rests in God's promise and Christ's finished work, not the believer's performance
- A believer's walk may falter; his eternal life does not (John 10:28–29)
- (Wilkin, Confident in Christ; Dillow, The Reign of the Servant Kings)

God's ability to guard us from stumbling is a resource we lean on for our walk; His ability to present us blameless is a certainty we rest on for our destiny.

From "kept" to "able to keep"

"To those who are the called, beloved in God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ" — Jude 1

"Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling" — Jude 24

Not with our effort, but with His ability; not with our glory, but with His. Amen.